CATEGORY OPERATIONS / HYDERABAD

Service Supply & Quality Optimization

Urban services category-management case | Sept 2026 synthetic simulation

Not affiliated with Urban Company. No private company data used.

BASELINE FILL	QUALITY-SAFE FILL	INCREMENTAL JOBS	ON-TIME GAIN
70.1%	91.5%	+412	+8.5 pp

01 The management problem

Uneven demand can leave one locality short of qualified service professionals while another has unused capacity. Broadening supply reach can lift fulfillment, but may worsen start-time punctuality, cancellations and complaints. The model asks which combination of supply sharing, professional onboarding and quality coaching offers the best balance.

02 Controlled scenario results (18-day evaluation set)

POLICY	COMPLETED	FILL %	ON-TIME / ALL	COMPLAINT %
Baseline	1,350	70.1	70.1	11.0
Zone Pooling	1,706	88.6	74.8	12.1
Pooling + Onboarding	1,750	90.9	78.1	12.1
Quality-Safe Playbook	**1,762**	**91.5**	**78.6**	**10.3**
Peak-Shift Experiment	1,757	91.3	76.6	10.0

Read the denominator: Baseline is 100% on time among completed orders because the assumed local-only travel proxy stays under 45 min; however, 29.9% of all customer requests are unfulfilled. On-time fulfillment out of all requests rises 70.13% to 78.60% with the recommended policy.

03 Operational decision

Recommended test: Adjacent-zone pooling + 12 screened/onboarded candidates + coaching for 57 low-rated synthetic existing professionals. Complete requests increase 1,350 to 1,762 (+412), and complaint incidence is 10.96% vs 10.33%. Program spending is an assumed ₹43,650 (~₹106 per added completion); this is not profit or realized ROI.

IMPLEMENTATION BLUEPRINT

From demand signal to operating SOP

04 How the model was built

01 Source context

Use public Hyderabad category listings and public professional-enablement materials for relevance; all model quantities declared synthetic.

02 Generate operations

Create 2,954 seeded requests, 96 existing professionals, and 45 candidate records in 8 illustrative zones over 28 days.

03 Plan without leakage

Use days 1–10 only for demand-to-supply shortage-pressure ranking; reserve days 11–28 for scenario scoring.

04 Execute dispatch

Match trade, slot, available capacity and home or adjacent zone; account for acceptance, cancellation, simulated travel and complaints.

05 Evaluate and stress-test

Compare five policies; evaluate 5 seeded runs under normal, 15% higher demand and 10% lower partner availability.

05 Key guardrails and practical lessons

- Do not confuse assignment, completion, conditional punctuality and punctuality across all incoming requests.
- Onboarding requires verified professional readiness and safety training; selection cannot be based on demand pressure alone.
- Peak-shift trial delivered 76.57% on-time fulfillment, below the quality-safe 78.60%; do not implement without pilot.
- Travel time is an assumed one-hop proxy, NOT route data or an official 45-minute UC SLA.
- Professional earnings, opt-in flexibility, wages, individual rights and customer safety are not measured; field validation is necessary.

06 How to discuss this in a Category Manager interview

"I analyzed why high customer demand does not automatically translate to completed home-service bookings. I built a reproducible simulation of qualified supply, matching and quality outcomes, identified a fill-rate and punctuality trade-off, and recommended a pilot-ready approach with clear operational controls. The improvements are counterfactual model outputs, not company results."

PUBLIC BUSINESS CONTEXT

Urban Company public Hyderabad service catalog; Urban Company Investor Relations: Service Professional Enablement (June 2024); user-provided campus Category Manager JD, p.2. Model inputs and limitations documented in the GitHub README.